Imperial Armor: Mundigura Jungle Wars

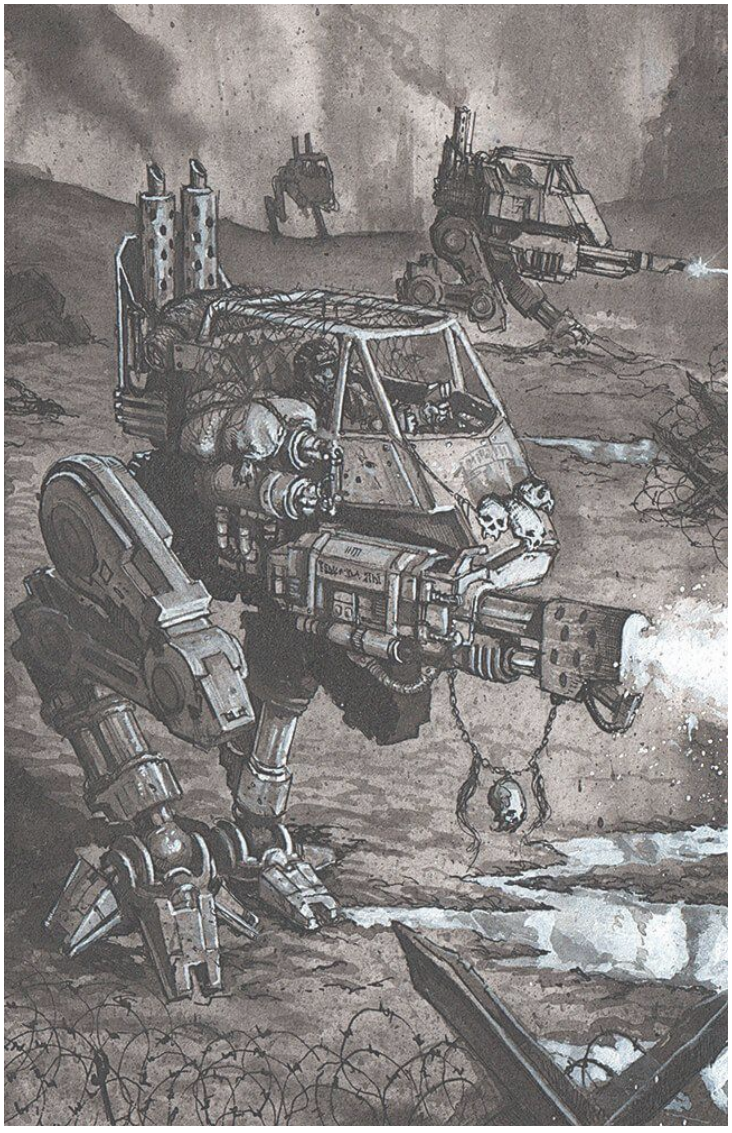
Charlie Don't Surf



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By Vincent Vlaisavich

The Planet of Mundigura is a planet that is vitally important to the Imperium. A mining planet producing more ore than the next three subsectors around it and being one of the most important mining worlds in the Uhulis Sector of Segmentum Tempestus. To give up on such a planet would be the Imperium giving up on its own production of much needed war-machines and weapons, to fuel the everlasting wars across the galaxy. These are the stories of the Mundigura Jungle Wars, an embarrassment upon the Imperium and a loss that created an entirely new Traitor Guard Warband. Unfamiliar regiments will face down knowledgeable militia in brutal jungle guerrilla warfare.



++It is not the strength of thy blade, but the strength of thy faith++

Mundigura

Lying in the far south of Segmentum Tempestus in the Uhulis Sector the world of Mundigura is distinctly unique for its rich ores and thus giving it the designation of "mining world". Its equator features deserts spanning 300 terran miles in length. In the middle of Mundigura's deserts lies the capital city of Kartaris. At the edges of the deserts to the North and the South lies thousands of miles of jungles. Thousands of mining camps dot the land pulling hundreds metric tons of ore daily to be sent to the forgeworlds of the Adeptus Mechanicus. Its jungles are as unsafe as most imperial death worlds with only a few limited trails making certain that imperial laborers have at least a cursory degree of safety under the jungle canopy. Still many Mundigurans fear ferocious animals like the Undergrowth Spine-Ripper and the Shabnak Step Demon. This is a hot and humid planet that would test any group of warfighters, even those adept in the art of jungle warfare.

Mundiguran PDF

Out of necessity and as ordered by the Adeptus Administratum the planetary governor of Mundigura maintains an intense number of PDF guardsmen. To outfit such a large organization much of the weaponry and equipment of the planetary defense force was built on the planet in the capital city of Kartaris. The Mundiguran pattern autogun could be built with or without a stock to be made useful in the cramped conditions of jungle warfare. PDF companies were taught to requisition and perhaps even produce their own ammunition. In fact, the formations of the PDF were trained specifically to make use of the jungles that cover most of the planet and each company was trained to be their own force of resistance amongst the hot and humid jungles. Alongside its autoguns; the PDF made great use of flamers and sniper rifles. The Mundigura PDF was mainly a hypermobile rapid reaction force. Thus it makes use majoritively of Chimera Armored Transports and Sentinels. Sometimes a rare Leman Russ Main Battle Tank or Hellhound Flamer Tank may join a formation, but such a thing is often seen in only the most direct attacks or a particularly big show of force. The PDF General Arvel Taun was a decorated tactician and oftentimes would personally take part in many battles fought by the Mundiguran Traitor PDF.

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The Seeds of Doubt

It is unknown when heresy truly began to spread amongst the populace of Mundigura, but the earliest known move down the ruinous path came when the planet's most influential preacher named Deacon Arnar began to tell of the four sides of the emperor in his sermons. The Emperor's strength, his speed and perfection, his mastery of planning in domestic and military matters, and finally; his promise of peace, his entropy, so that he brings all by his side next to the golden throne. Parishioners were encouraged by the influential preacher to even pick their favorite aspect and make moves to embody that style. This was years before any open heresy would be noted amongst the ranks of the PDF and civilian populace. At first small worship groups formed; each no more than ten or so civilians and PDF would study the ideas given to them by the preacher. Each group would grow on their own with the advice of the preacher's holy cabinet helping them to spread the word and their studies. As the cults were engorged and disciples of cults were formed and radicalized the preacher then began to tell of an enemy within; someone on the planet was a heretic, in fact that someone may in fact be the many. That this silent majority that was the true believers need to root out and encourage their closest compatriots to attend more often and to get involved. Then it came so suddenly. The Deacon had corrupted most of the PDF and a grand portion of the civilian populace. The enemy was the planetary governor and his crooks; that he had been allowed to live lavishly off the backs of the hardworking Mundiguran citizenry and that he was ineffective and needed to be deposed. With the support of the PDF General Arvel Taun and nearly two regiments of guardsmen and a whipped up angry mob; A coup had been successfully executed.

The Khagan Jungle Warriors

The Departmento Munitorum decided that given the utmost importance of the world of Mundigura and its resources a full four Regiments of the Khagan Jungle Warriors from the world of Khagan arrive on planet with Imperial Laborers to take over the mines alongside the Khagan regiments. The Khagan Jungle Warriors are incredibly skilled in setting ideal ambushes and attempting to win most engagements in one decisive blow- often either to their own detriment or the extreme annoyance of their enemy. Thus, they are almost impossible to catch in a trap or an ambush, even equaling the Catachan jungle fighters in their ability to set and spot the traps set by the Mundiguran PDF. The world of Khagan is many dense jungle oases dotted across multiple savannas and deserts giving the Khagan Jungle Warriors a well practiced knowledge of Jungle and Open-field combat. The Khagan Jungle warriors wear heavy gambeson and parka style flak armor that is adorned with tribal markings and bones of hunted beasts. Their captains and ridemasters often wear the pelts of the Khagan Oasis-Leaper on their shoulders-

keeping the culture of Khagan as that of the warrior- hunter and master trapper these leaders earn their respect by hunting them personally. With that being said the Khagan Jungle Warriors had won the war within over a month- the Capital City of Kartaris had been retaken and the laborers were back to work planetwide. The Departmento Munitorum decided that within a year the silence and relative inactive nature of the war called for the reduction of the Khagan Jungle Warriors to just the 15th Khagan Regiment; as the Khagan Jungle Warriors would be indispensable across the Segmentum in fighting a Tyranid Hive Fleet incursion across Segmentum Obscurus. With such small numbers it immediately became notable that heresy was spreading amongst the imperial laborers and eventually the first mining camp in the southern jungle went silent. Cults began rising up and despite the valiant effort of the Khagan 15th Regiment it was nearly wiped out to a man when they entirely sent themselves into the southern Jungles to find the location of the rising cults.

Kartaris

The main hub city of Mundigura and the only part of the planet that looks inhabited by a post industrial society. Within Kartaris sits a spaceport, PDF base of operations (which in the latter years of the war would house the Imperial Guard command and control), the Mundiguran Holy Amphitheater, the Governors Palace as the biggest buildings visible from orbit. The sprawl is made up of over four housing blocks, three industrial megaplexes, and an overwhelming seven warehousing complexes all around the spaceport. The city has a main highway running a loop through it with exits crossing out towards the interior and exterior jungle-bound highways. Dotted for miles outside the city are slums and huts, with many villages within a hundred miles of this main city. It is the only part of the planet that could even be approximated to civilized, the people within the city still carry their jungle origins, fashioning effigies from nails and scrap metal, tattoos, and hab wide night watches organized by the elders. Mixed in with the STC complaint buildings amongst the habitation quarters are vine overgrowths planted and maintained by the people that live in them. Many attempts by the Adeptus Arbites and local PDF (to which…limited at best effort was given) to maintain the compliance with STC guidelines have failed to get rid of the overgrowth, leading to two minor uprisings that had to be put down brutally. It seems that the people of Mundigura are as stubborn as they are traditional. It has been agreed upon by the majority of the ruling class on the planet that so long as the ore flows and the factories meet quota, then why should it really matter if the hab blocks have some vines on them?

A note on the ruling class and the Palace; The Mundiguran Planetary Government is starkly different to the rest of the planet. This would probably be the main reason that the people rebelled in the first place. The palace is shining with gold and silver, adorned with many aquilas. From offworld come hundreds of scribes and thousands of administrators to help facilitate the transport of Mundigura’s rich ore. These

groups are treated with suspicion and hostility by the populace and in turn looked down upon by the scribes and administrators. Up in the mid and high level of the palace sits the ruling. family of Mundigura- all would be killed and paraded in the streets at the beginning of the Mundigura Jungle Wars. Protected by autoturrets and the governor's personal guard a life of luxury is lived out where the only worry is whether or not everyone down below is doing all their supposed to. To that extent a very loose eye is kept by the governor, allowing for treachery to spread underneath him.
Directly below the governing bodies of Mundigura is the High Cardinal and the representatives of the Imperial Faith- The Adeptus Ministorum. Long standing tensions between the Ministorum and Mundigura government has caused both parties to be closed off and at times hostile towards each other.

Towards the end of the war both the palace and the Mundiguran Holy Amphitheater would be entirely levelled with Hab Block 726-A being the location of the final stand of the abandoned Mundiguran PDF and their rabble of cultists.

The Mundiguran Mining Complexes

Dotted across the jungles of Mundigura large extraction complexes worked by thousands of laborers draw hundreds of tons of ore daily from the surface. These complexes still pale in comparison to the backdrop of the thousands upon thousands of miles of jungles, but beyond the city of Kartaris and some underlying poor villages this is the extent of all human presence on the planet. People live, sleep, play, and die all in these mining complexes; some are born to never see the outside of the complex, or they may run off to join the Guard, PDF, or try their luck with the Mundiguran Mud-People. These complexes are mostly open air prisons spanning the size of several city blocks, with overseers and PDF working around the clock to keep the imperial laborers working; other locations are more voluntary with the populace essentially having a complex built next to their village and in exchange for food, medical equipment, and a safer homestead they work the mines.

It is a grueling work; but it does provide the Mundiguran populace with a base level skill at tunneling, which would play a role in the future Jungle Wars. The extraction sites can go miles down into the rich crust of Mundigura, sometimes shifts lasting days with only a day or two off are to be expected. Down in the dark caverns Mundiguran fauna can get in, explosives may collapse a tunnel, or a whole number of things may happen. It takes thousands of years for a mine to dry up, but when it does it is often abandoned and forgotten, retaken by the jungles and lost to time. Many dense jungles on Mundigura may have one or two still standing concrete buildings that hide secrets or abandoned technology, ripe for the taking.

Jungles of Mundigura and Flora

Running from nearly edge to edge on the planet of Mundigura is a vast and nearly unconquered jungle thousands upon thousands of miles wide. This is where the majority of the planet's freshwater reserves lie and where the most resource extraction takes place. Rivers run between hills and through valleys covered in trees, trails and settlements being the only sign of humanity for hundreds of miles. Hot and sticky with vines and shrubs covering the ground. Moving across even the lighter vegetation is a struggle for even the most fit and strong guard regiments, only those specialized in Jungle Warfare ever having a chance.

A unique property of the jungles of Mundigura and the flora that accompanies it is the bioluminescent Sensi Shrub. Around two hours after sunset and two hours before sunrise the tips of the plants' leaves will glow a light green color. This can often be when predators are out hunting the most since this gives the animal a distinct advantage. Biolumiscence isn't just for the Sensi Shrub alone; some trees and even vines will glow as well, these all seem to grow together in the thickest parts of the jungles on Mundigura and it is entirely inconclusive why this happens, however, they are everywhere on the planet. Often this leads to armies operating in dawn and dusk raids to have a difficult time seeing out of the dense foliage.

On top of this there are a number of dangerous plants that inhabit the jungles of Mundigura; whether it be the rare Mundigura Punji plant or the giant Venus Man Trap (a plant that can be found on many planets across the imperium.), to venomous shrubs that cause horrific and awful pain at the merest brush. The Jungles of Mundigura will often give way to many horrific surprises even in the kindest of jungle regions.

The Jungles not only hold many dangerous plants, but also dangerous animals. While pertaining to the Jungle Wars themselves, the animals that inhabit the Jungle are generally known to retreat from any combat zone, some animals are too curious (or hungry) to run away from combat and will sometimes be involved in combat. All in all the Mundigura Jungles are harsh to survive and only a few human settlements like the Mundigura Mud-People are able to live in harmony with the Jungle.

The Fengorn Mobile Infantry

Ill equipped for the Jungle and out of element the Fengorn Mobile Infantry would struggle for many years in the early war to gain ground against the experienced Mundiguran Jungle Fighters; who made the jungles their home and base of operations. The Fengorn Mobile Infantry is a proud fighting force, coming

out of a successful revolution on the gas giant planet of Fengorn. The only human habitation being vast honeycombs of floating hydrogen extractor cities that float far above the atmosphere. The Fengorn Mobile Infantry excels in urban conflict, they often try to set many tiny ambushes and skirmish their enemy to pieces; they make great use of the Griffon Mortar carrier as a light and accurate reactive artillery piece. Fengorn infantry are well equipped and modelled after Cadian Shock Troops. They utilize the Kantrael pattern lasgun and make great use of its sniper variant to harass a foe in street to street engagements. They love to use veteran formations with heavy allocations of shotguns and close-quarters weaponry. The Fengorn Mobile Infantry even employs its own variant of the famed Cadian Kasrkin; Fengorn Shock Brigadiers. The nature of their homeworld and their chosen combat style makes the Fengorn Mobile Infantry particularly adept at void warfare, often being used across the Gothic Sector for boarding actions. They're one of the few regiments that tend to actually get along well with the Aeronautica Imperialis for this reason, often being comparable to elite voidsmen in ideal conditions. Given the nature of the Imperium it is considerably difficult for the Fengorn Mobile Infantry and Aeronautica Imperialis to "arrange" joint operations, however, many a high admiral will try and create happenstance surrounding them. The Fengorn Mobile Infantrymen that partook in the Mundiguran Jungle Wars have gathered fame with the little bits of their regiment that remain as a versatile guerilla fighting force the Fengorn 87nd persists onward.

The Second Battle for Kartaris

The official opening of the Mundiguran Jungle Wars would start with the second battle of Kartaris, this would be the single most massive urban engagement of the whole war featuring five regiments of Fengorn Mobile Infantry and four regiments of Vostroyan Firstborn engaged with approximately twenty five to thirty regiments of Mundiguran Traitor PDF. A bloodbath lasting two terran months started with the blitz of the spaceport and particularly hard light mechanized combat across the highways of Kartaris. All the hab blocks of Kartaris would be teeming with dregs and cultists who had planned every street and every opening. It was the type of combat both the Fengorn Mobile Infantry and the Vostroyan Firstborn were made for. Several famous sniper duels would take place in the dockyards around the spaceport. Most notably between Sergeant Harding of the Fengorn Mobile Snipers and the 'Grey One' a mutated heretek sniper.

It is notable that this is one of the last times the Traitor PDF General and the Apostate Cardinal would be able to work together. This particular detail would actually benefit Mundiguran tactics greatly, both sides disagreed on the proper strategies for war. Mundiguran PDF lives would be spent dearly in the second

battle for Kartaris and the Fengorn Mobile Infantry would launch a daring raid on the great Basilica of Mundigura. A general assault made by the Fengorn 912th on the Basilica paired with a deep strike by the Fengorn 32nd Shock Brigade would threaten the life of the Apostate Cardinal towards the end of the Second Battle for Kartaris. Room to room and balcony to balcony fighting would take place while the cardinal's personal guard desperately held off the Fengorn Mobile Infantry in the cardinal's chambers. After the Vostroyan Firstborn regiments had captured most of the hab blocks and the dockyards after a month of fighting from the space port operations- a generalized withdrawal was ordered to both the north and the south jungles. The cardinal would somehow escape the Fengorn Mobile Infantry while thousands of cultists died in a desperate final stand in the Basilica. The day had been won and the Imperial Guard began to build out a base for high command in the old PDF Stronghold.

The Mundiguran Jungle Fighters would be harassed and suffer further casualties at the hands of the Aeronautica Imperialis across the deserts surrounding Kartaris and the equator of Mundigura. It is unknown how many of the traitor guardsmen met their end, but given how long they would hold on in the jungles over the next twelve years it is probable that not a major dent was made by the bombing raids. In fact moreover, given the weight of the near decade and a half of fighting it is possible that even though costly- the urban operation in Kartaris was fought by only fifteen percent of the total population of the Mundigurans.

The Vostroyan Firstborn

The Vostroyan Firstborn are a regiment born of great pride and craftsmanship, they specialize in urban and winter warfare…thus making them a terrible choice for jungle warfare. However, given an oversight by the departmento munitorum, this is precisely where they have ended up. The Vostroyan Firstborn hail from a region of space called the Halo Stars around the Eye of Terror, they are a bulwark of the Imperium often sending regiments to distress calls that rarely go answered by other regiments. Since post Horus Heresy due to great shame, the Vostroyan Firstborn give all their first sons to the Imperial Guard to pay penance for a slight made ten thousand years ago.

The Vostroyan Firstborn are largely a technocracy and adhere to their social structure even in the ranks of the Guard. This means that Vostroyan commanders are often noble born and can only be noble born, while the regular infantry are commoners and can only be commoners. Their only hope for promotion being to the level of squad lead or platoon command. Another piece of Vostroyan culture is the tendancy to form strong brotherhoods within their ranks, meaning that Vostroyan morale is often high. Vostroya

will reinforce their own regiments when they get the chance, meaning that every regiment has a long and storied past. Further increasing morale amongst the regiments of Vostroya.

The Vostroyan Firstborns often look down on other Imperial Guard Regiments, their lack of skill and tech making them look inferior to the Vostroyan Firstborn. This would be one of the few wars that gained the respect of the Firstborn. The Fengorn Mobile Infantry's tendency to have higher technological aptitude and great skill in urban warfare meant that even in the early days of the second battle for Kartaris the Vostroyans had seen reason to pay respect. This bond would be furthered through the traumatic Jungle Wars on Mundigura where both sides had to wholly put aside differences to survive in the nightmarish jungles of this death world.

Start of the Mundigura Jungle Wars

The Mundigura traitor PDF would split in twain, now cut off from each other they became two independent fighting forces desperately holding on for survival. To the North were the Cardinal's forces who had robust ranks of cultists and elite disciples. To the South; the PDF General, who had the majority of the standard issue PDF guardsmen.

It was obvious from the onset that there was going to be no grand open battles, that this was going to be a guerilla war…and a messy one. The Aeronautica Imperialis would do sweeping recon missions over the jungles, which they would find very little in the way of tangible strongpoints amongst the thick canopy below. So the guard went in blind, selecting points they might be able to set up camps and forward operating bases. The opening days of the Jungle Wars were silent, occasional long abandoned camps from the earlier week's retreat. Most guard platoons would be split into halves or even quarters and sent on patrol through the jungle. The Fengorn Shock Brigadiers would go on deep action patrols into specific deep valleys thought to harbor traitors…for nearly two days the feeling amongst the warriors of the imperium was that potentially they could have made a much larger dent than what they had initially thought during the urban operations. Then at dawn of the third day of jungle operations all hell broke loose. Firebases across the jungle reported being flooded with cultists to the north, the cardinal looked to either be probing or even outright attacking locations.

In the south it was a much much different story, the jungle fight here was fought very differently. A silent killer of whole platoons was taking hold. A platoon would march into the jungle and then panicked radio calls would come through and be cut short and then a reclamation force sent in to find nothing but guard

corpses. The regions that most disappeared into was where the imperial guard began to focus more heavily on and send in multiple platoons at a time supported by sentinels and artillery.

Over time in the southern jungles the guard would find the occasional ammo cache or pillbox, but the enemy seemed to be set up well and thin with rapid reaction forces to find smaller forces.

Firebase Constantine

The Cardinal's counter offensive seemed to focus hard on one firebase in particular, with very little aid and not much support the guard forces there were under threat of being completely overrun by the cultist hordes. Moreover, it would seem that the hardy and elite disciples had begun to appear.

For four days the firebase would hold its perimeter, sometimes there would be a brief pause. Most mornings would bring about an ever growing mortar barrage that would take place, with another cultist wave, followed by disciples. It would be day for that the perimeter of the firebase was breached and fighting over the vast "tent city" as the guard called it would be relatively brief, mostly a running retreat to the inner defenses of the firebase. By this time the Valkyrie port behind the inner defense would be running at high readiness to launch all aircraft away from the firebase and towards Kartaris. For two days the fight for the inner defenses would be held before the imperial guard launched a recapture order for it and shuffled forces via Valkyrie insertion. The next day, through aeronautica imperialis support and three companies of imperial guard the perimeter was re-established and the cultist waves fell back after a monumental artillery strike by the 56th Vostroyan Artillery Corps.

[map of firebase here]

The attack on firebase Constantine caused imperial command in Kartaris to be heavily concerned. This was a major military base in the region that had been raided and overwhelmed during the major jungle offensive. For the most part, however, most forward operation bases and artillery bases seemed to be left untouched by the limited offensive.

Sheffield Valley Counter Offensive

A mining cluster in the Sheffield Valley that had been overlooked defensively for a while had been overrun during the Cardinals Offensive. This seventeen square mile region had over twenty five mines and ore extraction sites within it. This offensive was fought across Mundigura's Jungles with limited open

clearings and jungle habitations, often the side attacking a mine or ore extraction would have the advantage of the thick jungle, this meant that for either side actually holding territory was almost impossible. Both sides began utilizing some degree of traps. It was here that Captain Jacobs of the Fengorn Mobile Infantry 12th would utilize the platoons allocation of explosives to great effect single-handedly routing an enemy force of company strength- he would die on his return trip to a Mundiguran Venus Man Trap. His actions would get him recommended for the Eagle Ordinary posthumously.

While victories were made in places, bitter defeats were experienced in others. On the fourth day of this offensive operation the mining complex of D-34b which had been held by a lightly mechanized platoon in the rear had been attacked by a force consisting of reportedly 3 platoon strength of disciples. With the battle in the rear lasting six hours and over 75% of the chimera armored transports labelled functionally destroyed and a further 57% of the elements sentinel walker supports had been lost. All the while the whole force in the 17 square mile zone had bogged down due to high concentrations of the cardinal's elements.

Maybe even more peculiar was the new forces beginning to appear in this part of the jungle. Various reports of humanoids warped and changed…a heretic would appear with bird legs, stalks that protrude five or six inches from their face housing eyes, sometimes the mutations would prove useful for the mutant; in sector 3 deep in the Jungle a squad led by junior officer Ferris would report something that looked like it could've been human once- lurking up in the trees above them with spider like arms and clawed hands picking them off one by one. It would be days before it was found by a sniper squad when it was moving from sector 3 to sector 4. The sniper squad put a round through its head and it still moved around and crawled up a tree and fell back down before curling up and dying after ten seconds of being headless. Across the front the story was beginning to be similar everywhere- a spreading rot amongst the ranks of heretic soldiers, their skin covered in pustules, the mutants moving through the underbrush, and a general feeling in the air. The generals in Kartaris had made requests for increased commissariat postings in the Northern Jungles. The generals knew what was in store.

So it was that after two weeks of fighting in the Sheffield valley and very minimal gains the imperial guard would launch another counteroffensive, focused now wholly on the rearward sectors where the mutant reports were highest. Fighting would last another week with little to note except for the same back and forth work, until the last mining complex was seized. Troops would stay to guard it and check the

tunnels which held a small core of cultists and then Imperial laborers were sent forward and the operation considered a success.

Post operation another silence in the Northern Jungles would take over, as if the battles of Firebase Constantine and the Sheffield Valley Counter Offensive turned off a faucet, there were still hundreds of thousands of mining complexes that would be seized and still patrols would be ambushed, but overall the front would remain in limbo. Nothing notable would happen in the North for some time.

Aesir Peak Offensive

While the counteroffensive in the North was taking place, another offensive on the Imperial side was brewing. Jungle patrols around and on the peak were being ambushed and attacked at an intense rate. With no buildings, fortifications, or clear evidence of the hills' use. So the plan would be simple, make way for a forward operating base to secure the hill and take control of the region. In theory this would take as long as the amount of time building the FOB would take, however, Imperial forces would kick a hornets nest in the Southern Jungles.

Morning of the burgeoning offensive would come with a full company being airlifted into the Jungle and sent on a long range march towards Aesir Peak, upon which the element was assailed by an element of traitor PDF number at least a platoon’s strength. With artillery support called in and confirmed the element was able to advance further into the jungles towards the peak. Then several static positions opened up, crippling the company's advance. It was by the action of Platoon Baker that the whole force wasn’t wiped out, when the platoon advanced on a hill from its flank and took out heretic forces manning a mortar nest, taking heavy casualties in the act and the pull out from the hill, platoon baker would be absorbed into another platoon later as veterans. With the company still pinned and its elements taking casualties rapidly, it would be the command of Company Commander Mestina Juarez that would push the company forward through the day. Mestina was known for his level of coolness under fire, constantly smoking an LHO or when he got the chance, a cigar. There was a legend amongst the company from an earlier operation where Mestina had been calling out orders to his platoons with a LHO stick hanging out of his mouth when a sniper round caught the tip of his LHO and put it out, to which caused him to rant and curse in the general direction of where the round came from before relighting it and walking away. There were very few men amongst his company that wouldn’t follow Mestina to their deaths. He was already in contact with the firebases in the region to rush resources out to him, but he was also committing his platoons to a multi-tiered advance through the jungle, but trying to outflank and take out static positions causing harm to his advance. The problem being, the traitor PDF general clearly put a lot

of thought into this region and new flanks would find themselves pinned by completely new static positions. The enemy had dug in tight and it appeared that the men of the Fengorn Mobile Infantry had a chance to knock out a major heretic stronghold. Command, seeing the opportunity, sent forth four more companies into the Jungle and rushed to call for strike fighters to be placed on round the clock calls for the remainder of the offensive action. Via rapid airlift the companies touched down and began to support Mestina's advance, a full regiment strength force had been committed to the region.

As the regiment element advanced and reached the base of Aesir Peak a mass ambush from all sides had commenced and a tunnel entrance had been identified. Changing the whole tempo of the offensive entirely. A stronghold underground had been found and now the guard was going to have to fight underground if they wanted to clear out the heretics from Aesir Peak. The veterans combined from shattered platoons like those of platoon baker were ordered by Colonel Mestina to join him in the first expedition into the tunnels. The expedition had found the tunnels went deep and were very reinforced. Moreover, they were loaded with infirmaries, armories, and defensive structures and static positions. Of the thirty men that went on the first tunnel expedition only half returned. While the tunnels remained manned and enemy presence remained entrenched, the tempo of the operation had shifted to something entirely new. The regiment began to envelop the base of Aesir Peak and find individual tunnel entrances. In the first two days of the envelopment operations the regiment had found over 15 tunnel entrances each heavily defended and with their own multilayered network of static positions.

[Map of Aesir Peak at this point in the battle]